Ubon SW-211 Maxfit

I liked the screenless life, but data needs work

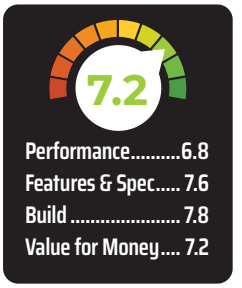
After smartwatches and smart rings, I think screenless fitness bands could be the next wearable category to get serious attention in India. A lot of that interest started with people discovering Whoop and its approach to tracking health and recovery without putting another screen on your wrist. Now, several India-based brands are trying to bring a similar idea to a much wider audience. One of them is Ubon with the SW-211 Maxfit.

Maxfit takes the screenless approach quite literally. There is no AMOLED panel, no touchscreen and no temptation to constantly check another notification on your wrist. Instead, it focuses on collecting health and fitness data in the background and pushing it to the companion app. Ubon is also pitching features such as HRV, stress and recovery tracking, more than 100 sports modes, long battery life and, importantly, a zero-subscription approach.

On paper, this sounds like exactly the kind of wearable I would want after spending years surrounded by screens. But I also wanted to see how much I can actually trust the numbers. So, during my time with the Maxfit, I compared several of its readings with those from my Apple Watch Series 12.

₹6,999





THE SCREENLESS LIFE

As a tech journalist, I am so used to having a screen on my wrist that wearing the Maxfit felt strange initially. There is no display to glance at, no touchscreen to swipe through and no notification panel demanding attention. At first, I missed all of that. After a few days, however, the absence of a screen started to feel soothing. The Maxfit itself looks fairly premium at first glance. My review unit had a black band paired with a metallic bronze-coloured panel, which gives it a more premium appearance than I expected. The overall grip is good, and I never felt that the band was going to slip off.

The strap quality is decent, although I did run into one annoying problem. After taking a bath, the material tends to remain wet for quite some time. Wearing it immediately afterwards can make the band feel itchy against the skin, which I didn't particularly enjoy.

The other issue is the size of the sensor assembly. The Maxfit isn't particularly cumbersome during the day, but the sensors make the underside feel slightly bulky. I didn't have much trouble going about my day, but sleeping with it was less comfortable.

That is worth mentioning because sleep and recovery are supposed to be among the biggest reasons to buy a wearable like this. If a band becomes uncomfortable at night, it can defeat part of the purpose.

There is also a physical button. A single press lets you check the connection status and battery level through the LED indicator, while a long press can initiate Bluetooth pairing or manually start and stop workout tracking. You can also hold it down for a few seconds to power on or off. It is a simple system, and I didn't really miss having a touchscreen once I got used to it.

In fact, the screenless approach ended up being one of my favourite things about Maxfit. Whenever I wanted to check my metrics, I opened the Da Halo app instead of looking at my wrist. It removed one more source of distraction from my day.

SLEEP TRACKING

Sleep is one of the areas where the Maxfit feels more useful than its relatively simple hardware might suggest. The Da Halo app gives you information such as awake time, sleep latency, sleep efficiency and the timing of your sleep. It then uses these metrics to provide an overall sleep score, which generally sat between 65 and 80 during my testing.

The presentation is easy enough to understand, but there is a limitation: the app mostly tells you what happened rather than why. You get the statistics, but there isn't much explanation about what caused the score or what you should change to improve it.

I also compared the sleep data with my Apple Watch Series 12. The broad picture was often similar, but Apple's tracking felt more precise and detailed. The Apple Watch gave me more context, and when the two differed, I found myself trusting the Apple Watch more.

For someone who simply wants a broad picture of their sleep without paying for a subscription, the information is useful. But if you are expecting a detailed recovery platform that can tell